

The Journal: a supporting act, done right

Our editorial is not the lead, and it should not try to be. Its job is to build authority, earn links, and feed the pages that actually convert. Today it is working against itself by living in the wrong place and going unmeasured. Here is the fix.

Team briefing · June 2026 · Source: Google Analytics, Search Console, Semrush, the Editorial Migration roadmap

First, the role: support, not lead

Gardens' bottleneck is conversion and positioning, not awareness. So the landing pages lead, and the Journal supports them.

Landing pages do triple duty: the page Google ranks, the page AI assistants cite, and the page our ads point to. The Journal is the slow-burn layer underneath: it builds topical authority, attracts links, and captures long-tail and informational interest that later flows to the commercial pages.

The trap to avoid: pouring effort into editorial volume, or rushing the migration, while the commercial pages (the family page, the luxury and Arenal pages) are still unbuilt. The Journal compounds

slowly; the landing pages move revenue now. Sequence accordingly.

It can work: we have proof

This is not a hypothetical channel. One article already does what we want the whole Journal to do.

ARTICLE	RANKS	SEARCH DEMAND	RESULT
"The Top 10 Travel Trends of 2026"	#5	14,800 / mo	The #2 organic page on the whole corporate site (about 8% of its organic traffic)

A single well-aimed editorial piece is pulling more non-brand traffic than almost any commercial page. Sustainability, regenerative-travel, and Arenal wildlife pieces also pull steady interest and are the kind of content AI assistants quote. The lesson: a few sharp, on-strategy articles beat a high volume of generic ones.

The three problems holding it back

1. It lives on a separate subdomain

The Journal sits on its own host (`blog.nayararesorts.com`) rather than as a folder on the main site. That splits authority: the links and trust the editorial earns do not fully pass to the

commercial domain that needs to rank. Moving it to `nayararesorts.com/journal` keeps that value on one site.

2. It is unmeasured

The editorial subdomain is not connected to Search Console, so we are flying blind on which articles rank, earn links, or get cited. We cannot manage what we cannot see.

3. Naming and consistency

It is the "Journal," and our own pages and prompts should say so everywhere. Consistent naming matters for brand and for how the section is understood.

What we are going to do about it

A careful migration plus a tighter editorial focus. This sits behind the commercial layer in Report 1, not ahead of it.

FOUNDATION

1

Connect the editorial subdomain to Search Console so we can finally see article performance and set a baseline. The gate for everything else. Owner: analytics / SEO

2

Standardize the name as "the Journal" across the site, navigation, and internal templates. Owner: content / web

MIGRATE CAREFULLY (ONE PROJECT, BEHIND THE LANDING PAGES)

1

Move the Journal to a folder on the main site (nayararesorts.com/journal) so its authority strengthens the commercial domain. Owner: dev / SEO

2

Redirect page by page, never in bulk. Every old article points to its exact new URL (redirecting everything to the homepage creates errors that lose the rankings). Redirects originate from the current content source. Retire dead pages cleanly and fix the Chile-versus-Costa-Rica tagging. Owner: dev / SEO

FOCUS THE EDITORIAL

1

Point new articles at the priority commercial pages, not at volume. Pieces that support family-in-Arenal, the luxury and Arenal pages, hot springs versus the competition, and a "which Nayara" comparison, each one feeding the page that converts. Owner: content

2

Build for credibility and AI citation: named author and expertise on each piece, real photography only, clear sourcing, and a structure assistants can quote. Owner: content / SEO

How we will know it worked

- **Baseline first:** once the subdomain is connected (step 1), we capture current article rankings, traffic, and links.
- **Migration health:** after the move, rankings hold or improve (no traffic lost to redirect errors), and authority consolidates on the main site.
- **The result that matters:** a small set of articles ranking and earning citations, measurably sending readers and trust to the family, luxury, and Arenal landing pages.

Honest expectation: the Journal pays off slowly and as a supporting channel. Judge it on authority, links, and assisted conversions to the commercial pages, not on standalone traffic vanity.

Report 2 of 5 in the Nayara digital strategy series. Previous: Organic Search. Next: Google Business Profile and Local, then Social, then Paid. Figures are from live analytics for the stated period; recommendations are steps to ship and measure, not completed work.